Data Mesh Readiness Assessment — Proposal Input Form

Information to be collected in the customer meeting and the proposal field each item fills. Once the form is completed and returned, the proposal text is produced.

Rows marked ● are BLOCKERS — the proposal cannot be written without them and they cannot be filled with assumptions.

If rows marked ○ remain missing, they are written into the proposal as assumptions and go to section 5.

If the answer to a question is "we don't know", that is also an answer — it is often the first finding and goes into the proposal as an assumption.

THE NUMBER OF DOMAINS AND THE INTERVIEW PLAN SET THE SCHEDULE: in each domain at least one head, one data owner and one consumer are interviewed. Customer effort is the highest in the family and grows with the number of domains; it cannot be reduced by adding people on the Komtaş side.

The evidence is mostly organisational — documents, role assignments, decision records, interviews. This package has no access model choice. Where a catalogue or platform exists, values such as the number of products and access-request times are used as measurement evidence if the customer shares them.

THIS FORM IS FOR SERVICE B — the ten dimensions (D1–D10) are placed on the five-level ladder per domain (current and target); the gate is run per domain; a readiness matrix, a pilot domain recommendation, a prerequisite closing plan and a transition plan are produced. There is no weighted score.

The report opens with a decision sentence, not with a maturity level: "domain X can start on date Y; domain Z cannot start until … is closed."

If the customer only wants a short first view of whether the domains can start today, the right service is A and A's own input form is used.

If an A engagement has previously been carried out for this customer, the evidence inventory produced is reused and deducted from B's effort — this is stated in the proposal.

A. Organisation and Proposal Details

	TO ASK	WHERE IT FILLS IN THE PROPOSAL	ANSWER
●	**Organisation and legal entities in scope — single company or group**	Cover, 1. Executive Summary — «CUSTOMER», «legal entities in scope»	
○	Proposal addressee — name, title, unit	Cover, 9. Proposal Terms — «full name», «title»	
○	Proposal date and expected decision date	Cover «dd Month yyyy», 9. validity «proposal date + 1 month»	
●	**Is there an RFP or specification; if so, its number and response format**	Structure of the whole proposal, 2.4 source column «RFP / statement»	
○	Procurement process and approval steps	9. Proposal Terms	

B. Decision — What the Assessment Will Support

Data mesh is an organisational decision, not a technology decision; the decision maker is usually the CDO or above.

If this section cannot be answered, the engagement reads like "explaining mesh" and its price cannot be defended.

	TO ASK	WHERE IT FILLS IN THE PROPOSAL	ANSWER
●	**Which decision will this assessment support — which domain to start with and when, organisational change, platform investment, reducing the load on the central team**	1. Executive Summary «DECISION», 2.1 Purpose of the Programme	

	TO ASK	WHERE IT FILLS IN THE PROPOSAL	ANSWER
●	**Has the data mesh decision been taken, or is it an option to be assessed**	1. Executive Summary, 5.1 Assumptions	
○	What is the most frequent complaint today — queue at the central team, data hard to find, unclear ownership	P1 focus dimensions	
○	Has a mesh or domain initiative been tried before; what was the outcome	5.1 Assumptions, recurring pattern check	
○	How will success be measured — which outcome counts as “done”	1. Executive Summary	

C. Sponsor and Senior Management Access

> This assessment is not carried out without interviewing the domain heads. If access to the senior management calendar is hard, P1 extends; this cannot be offset by adding people.

	TO ASK	WHERE IT FILLS IN THE PROPOSAL	ANSWER
●	**Who is the sponsor — can a CDO or data organisation lead be named**	7.3 Governance and Reporting, 5.3 Assumptions	
●	**How will access to the domain heads and the senior management calendar be arranged — easy, medium, hard**	Driver 9, 2.4 «CALENDAR ACCESS», 6. Project Plan, 7.2	
○	Who will make the decision, and by what date	6. Project Plan, 9. validity	
○	Who will the report be presented to — the data team or senior management	1. Executive Summary, 4. Deliverables	

D. Domain Scope

> The number of domains is the main sizing driver; narrowing the scope by domain is a far more effective lever on the schedule than reducing the number of dimensions.
>
> Komtaş does not draw domain boundaries. The boundary is the organisation’s decision; the assessment measures whether it is written down and consistent.

	TO ASK	WHERE IT FILLS IN THE PROPOSAL	ANSWER
●	**Names and number of the domains in scope**	Driver 1, 2.4 «DOMAINS» and «N»	
●	**Are the domain boundaries written down; is it defined which data belongs to which domain**	Gate item 1, dimension D1, 5.1 Assumptions	
○	Are overlapping data areas between domains known	Dimension D1, P1 focus	
○	Does the domain definition follow the business organisation or system boundaries	Dimension D1	
○	Are any domains, units or legal entities to be excluded from scope	2.5 Out of Scope	

E. Scale and Interview Plan

	TO ASK	WHERE IT FILLS IN THE PROPOSAL	ANSWER
●	**Estimated number of people to interview and their split by domain — head, data owner, consumer**	Driver 2, 2.4 «N», 6. Project Plan, 7.2	
○	Current size and workload of the central data team	Driver 4, 2.4 «N», dimension D9	

	TO ASK	WHERE IT FILLS IN THE PROPOSAL	ANSWER
○	Will consumer representatives take part in the interviews	Dimension D8, 7.2	
○	Will the engagement be run remotely, on site or hybrid	5.4 «remotely / on site / hybrid»	

F. Dimension Scope

All ten dimensions are in scope by default. If a dimension is excluded, the gate item it feeds stays statement-based only; this is written into the proposal as a constraint.

	TO ASK	WHERE IT FILLS IN THE PROPOSAL	ANSWER
●	**Are all ten dimensions (D1–D10) in scope; is any dimension to be excluded**	2.3 Assessment Dimensions, «OUT-OF-SCOPE DIMENSION»	
○	Is any dimension to be covered in more depth	P1 focus dimensions, 3. Methodology	

G. Data Products and Catalogue

This section feeds dimensions D2, D7 and D8. Existing products are assessed on a sample against contract, SLA, versioning and quality criteria; this assessment is not a separate service but dimension D2.

	TO ASK	WHERE IT FILLS IN THE PROPOSAL	ANSWER
●	**Is anything called a “data product” today; how many**	Driver 3, 2.4 «N», dimension D2	
○	Is there a catalogue product; can the number of registered products and the access-request time be shared	Dimension D7, 5.2 — measurement evidence	
○	Do the products have a written contract, SLA and versioning rule	Dimensions D2 and D8	
○	Are the consumers of each product known	Dimension D8	
○	Can products be selected for review as a sample	P1, 4. Deliverables	

H. Platform and Self-Serve Publishing Path

The self-serve publishing path is the fourth gate item. Platforms are covered only for their ability to let domains publish; the maturity of the platform itself is the subject of the Lakehouse Assessment or the DWH Assessment.

	TO ASK	WHERE IT FILLS IN THE PROPOSAL	ANSWER
●	**Can a domain publish a data product without raising a ticket with the central team**	Gate item 4, dimension D3	
○	Which data platforms are in scope — warehouse, lakehouse, other; how many	Driver 5, 2.4 «N», 2.5 Out of Scope	
○	How much of environment provisioning, templates and automation is ready	Dimension D3	
○	Can a product be traced end to end from idea to publication	P1, observation evidence	
○	To what extent are lineage and metadata collected	Dimension D7	

I. Governance, Standards and Documentation

> Federated governance is not the removal of central standards. Without common rules, data does not join across domains.

	TO ASK	WHERE IT FILLS IN THE PROPOSAL	ANSWER
●	**Governance maturity — are cross-domain common standards (schema, keys, naming, quality) written, partial or absent**	Driver 7, 2.4 «GOVERNANCE STATUS», gate item 5, dimensions D4 and D5	
●	**Documentation maturity — are the organisation chart, domain definition, role assignments and standards written, partial or absent**	Driver 8, 2.4 «DOCUMENTATION STATUS», 5.2	
○	Who sets the standards and how is compliance monitored	Dimension D4	
○	Is there master data or common definition work	Dimension D5	
○	Are there regulated data areas	Dimension D4, 5.1 Assumptions	

J. Organisation, Capacity and Incentives

> This section is the core subject of the assessment. Most data mesh initiatives stop here: responsibility is handed over, capacity is not.
>
> Answers are usually optimistic; verification in P1 is based on named people and dedicated FTE.

	TO ASK	WHERE IT FILLS IN THE PROPOSAL	ANSWER
●	**Is there a named person in the domains who takes on data product ownership**	Gate item 2, dimension D1	
●	**Is there dedicated data engineering capacity within the domain — how many people**	Gate item 3, dimension D6	
○	Number of legal entities or locations	Driver 6, 2.4 «N»	
○	Will HR or the organisation side take part; has role definition or headcount work been done	Dimension D10, 7.2 Expected participation	
○	Has the new role of the central team been discussed	Dimension D9	

K. Pilot Domain and Target Levels

> The pilot is not the most willing domain but the one that best meets the prerequisites. The customer's candidate is tested against evidence in P3; candidate and recommendation may differ, and the report states the reason.
>
> The target level is the organisation's decision. If it is not set, it is set jointly in P0; this is written into the proposal as an assumption. For a first pilot domain, level three is enough in most dimensions.

	TO ASK	WHERE IT FILLS IN THE PROPOSAL	ANSWER
○	Which domain or domains are considered as pilot candidates; why	P3 pilot recommendation, 5.3 Assumptions, 4. Deliverables	
○	Target start date for the pilot	1. Executive Summary — decision sentence, 6. Project Plan	
○	Can a target level (1–5) be set for each of the ten dimensions; who will set it — the answer per dimension goes in the table below	2.3 Assessment Dimensions, P0 deliverable, 5.3	
○	Will the target level differ by domain	P0 deliverable, 5.3 Assumptions	

Target level per dimension. If it differs by domain, write it with the domain name. If unknown, leave blank; it is set jointly in P0 and written into the proposal as an assumption.

	DIMENSION	WHERE IT FILLS IN THE PROPOSAL	TARGET LEVEL (1–5) AND SET BY
○	D1 Domain boundaries and ownership	P0 deliverable, 5.3 Assumptions	
○	D2 Data product definition and quality criteria	P0 deliverable, 5.3 Assumptions	
○	D3 Self-serve platform capability	P0 deliverable, 5.3 Assumptions	
○	D4 Federated governance	P0 deliverable, 5.3 Assumptions	
○	D5 Interoperability and standards	P0 deliverable, 5.3 Assumptions	
○	D6 In-domain data engineering capacity	P0 deliverable, 5.3 Assumptions	
○	D7 Discoverability and catalogue	P0 deliverable, 5.3 Assumptions	
○	D8 Consumer experience and SLA	P0 deliverable, 5.3 Assumptions	
○	D9 Role of the central team and transition model	P0 deliverable, 5.3 Assumptions	
○	D10 Organisation, incentives and funding	P0 deliverable, 5.3 Assumptions	

L. Previous Work and Funding

	TO ASK	WHERE IT FILLS IN THE PROPOSAL	ANSWER
○	Has a data mesh, data organisation or data product assessment been done before — yes, partial, no	Driver 10, 2.4 «PREVIOUS ASSESSMENT», 5.1, baseline comparison	
○	Is data work funded centrally or by the domains; is an incentive model for the domains known	Dimension D10	

M. Commercial Framework

	TO ASK	WHERE IT FILLS IN THE PROPOSAL	ANSWER
○	Is there an approved budget	8. Project Fees — «fee»	
○	Schedule constraint — budget period, organisational change timetable, management presentation	6. Project Plan	
○	Are there competitors, and who	Emphasis and section weights	
○	Will pilot domain work also be discussed after the assessment	2.5 Out of Scope, follow-on proposal	

Domain Inventory — Worksheet

The answers from sections D and K are entered here. The gate columns are filled with a first estimate in P0 and with evidence in P2: Met · Partly met · Not met · Not assessed. This table is the input to the readiness matrix.

Gate columns — 1 BOUNDARY: is the domain boundary written down · 2 OWNER: is there a named product owner · 3 CAPACITY: is there a data engineer dedicated to the domain · 4 PLATFORM: can it publish without a ticket to the central team · 5 RULES: is there a commitment to the common standards.

#	DOMAIN	DOMAIN HEAD	1 BOUNDARY	2 OWNER	3 CAPACITY	4 PLATFORM	5 RULES	PILOT CANDIDATE
1								
2								
3								
4								
5								
6								
7								
8								

If one of the five gate items cannot be met within a foreseeable time, the domain gets Not ready; a high level in other dimensions does not offset this.

If an item is partly met, the result is Conditional and it is matched with an owner, a date and a dependency in the prerequisite closing plan.

If the whole table comes out Not ready, the result is that the organisation cannot move to data mesh today; this is also a valid assessment result.

Band Estimate — Worksheet

Completed after the answers are collected. The band is the highest band that at least three drivers fall into; a single large driver does not carry the band.

The durations below apply to Service B. For A, 1 / 1.5 / 2 weeks (6 / 9 / 12 pd) apply; A uses only drivers 1–6 and has its own input form.

#	DRIVER	SMALL	MEDIUM	LARGE	RESULTING BAND
1	Number of domains in scope	≤ 3	4 – 8	> 8	
2	Number of people to interview	≤ 12	12 – 30	> 30	
3	Number of existing data products	0 – 2	3 – 15	> 15	
4	Central data team size	≤ 5	5 – 20	> 20	
5	Number of data platforms in scope	1	2 – 3	> 3	
6	Number of legal entities or locations	1	2 – 3	> 3	
7	Current governance maturity	Written	Partial	None	
8	Current documentation maturity	Written	Partial	None	
9	Access to senior management calendar	Easy	Medium	Hard	
10	Previous assessment	Yes	Partial	No	
	RESULT — selected band and duration	3 weeks · 22 pd	3.5 weeks · 28 pd	4 weeks · 34 pd	

CUSTOMER EFFORT — small 6 days · medium 8 days · large 10 days. This is the highest in the family and grows with the number of domains; this expectation is stated explicitly in section 7.2 of the proposal.

PHASE BREAKDOWN (medium band indication) — P0 Scope 2 days · P1 Evidence and interviews 1–1.5 weeks · P2 Placement, gate and readiness matrix 3 days · P3 Pilot and transition plan 1 week · P4 Validation and publication 2 days.

The duration is set by the interview schedule, not by technical measurement. If driver 1 or 9 falls into the large band, the schedule extends even if the other drivers fall into the small band.

Blocker Checklist

These rows must be answered before proposal writing starts.

SECTION	BLOCKER QUESTION	ANSWERED?
A	Organisation and legal entities in scope — single company or group	
A	Is there an RFP or specification; if so, its number and response format	
B	Which decision will this assessment support — which domain to start with and when, organisational change, platform investment, reducing the load on the central team	
B	Has the data mesh decision been taken, or is it an option to be assessed	
C	Who is the sponsor — can a CDO or data organisation lead be named	
C	How will access to the domain heads and the senior management calendar be arranged — easy, medium, hard	
D	Names and number of the domains in scope	
D	Are the domain boundaries written down; is it defined which data belongs to which domain	
E	Estimated number of people to interview and their split by domain — head, data owner, consumer	
F	Are all ten dimensions (D1–D10) in scope; is any dimension to be excluded	
G	Is anything called a “data product” today; how many	
H	Can a domain publish a data product without raising a ticket with the central team	
I	Governance maturity — are cross-domain common standards (schema, keys, naming, quality) written, partial or absent	
I	Documentation maturity — are the organisation chart, domain definition, role assignments and standards written, partial or absent	
J	Is there a named person in the domains who takes on data product ownership	
J	Is there dedicated data engineering capacity within the domain — how many people	

IF ANY BLOCKER IS MISSING — the proposal is not written. If it must be written, each missing item is written into section 5 of the proposal as an assumption, and it is stated that the scope will be reassessed if that assumption does not hold.

The first row of section D is a special case: without the names and number of domains, no band can be chosen, no interview plan can be set up and no schedule can be given.